INDUSTRY STARTER PACKS FOR ENTERPRISE ARCHITECTS

Retail

The complete set — what is in it, what each piece is for, and the order to pick them up

Two volumes, six spreadsheets, three decks and the worked example they were all built against. Read this first: it says which file answers which question, and which three you need in your first week.

South African lens. Sourced throughout. October 2026.

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Thotnr Consulting

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GUIDE 1

What is in this set

Fifteen files. Three of them matter in your first week.

This set exists so that an architect who has never worked in a retailer can walk into one and be useful. Not eventually — within a quarter.

It comes in four parts and a worked example. The two books teach and instruct, the spreadsheets are what you actually fill in, the decks are what you put on a screen in front of other people, and the Halverson files are a complete, populated example of what the finished thing looks like.

Read these three first

> **IF YOU READ NOTHING ELSE**
>
> **`01 Learner guide`** — read it once, front to back, before you start. It is the industry.
>
> **`02 Workbook`** — never read front to back. Open it at the phase you are in and work the numbered steps.
>
> **`03 Excel templates / Retail_EA_Metamodel_TEMPLATE.xlsx`** — the empty repository. Everything the workbook tells you to do lands in it.

The whole set

Folder	File	What it is	When you use it
01	Retail — a starter pack for enterprise architects	The learner guide. 269 pages, 22 chapters.	Read once, keep beside you
02	Retail — the architecture workbook	The ADM workbook. 489 pages, 159 numbered steps, 30 printable forms.	Every working day
03	Retail_EA_Metamodel_TEMPLATE.xlsx	The empty repository. 111 sheets, with the change control the example lacks.	From day one
03	Retail_Architecture_Comparison_Tool_TEMPLATE.xlsx	Baseline against target, with the governed-drift test.	Phase E, then quarterly
03	Retail_EA_Workshop_Capture.xlsx	Live capture for the five workshops.	In the room
03	Retail_EA_Transcription_Forms.xlsx	30 forms matching the printed ones.	Typing up paper
03	Retail_EA_Principles_and_Standards.xlsx	49 principles, 31 standards, ready to adopt or argue with.	Preliminary phase
03	Retail_EA_Maturity_Assessment.xlsx	26 scored dimensions with the evidence for each.	First month, then annually
04	Retail_EA_Executive_Briefing.pptx	25 slides for the executive committee.	End of the first quarter
04	Retail_EA_View_Templates.pptx	45 slides: all 37 ArchiMate 4 views, empty and guided.	Whenever you draw
04	Retail_EA_Workshop_Pack.pptx	50 slides facilitating the five workshops.	In the room
05	Retail_TOGAF_Metamodel.xlsx	The worked example — a populated repository for an invented retailer.	When you want to see what finished looks like
05	Retail_ArchiMate4_Views.pptx	Worked ArchiMate 4 views of that repository.	Alongside the view templates

The two books, and why they are separate

	Volume 1 — the learner guide	Volume 2 — the workbook
Read	once, front to back	never front to back
Answers	what this industry is and how it runs	what do I do on Monday
Shelf life	keep it as reference	consumed — you write in it

Volume 1 covers the formats and lines of business, the vocabulary, the business model, who does what, how retailers actually make money, the operating model, the process model in BPMN, the data and information models, the application landscape, the reference architectures such as they are, the providers, the regulator, and how to model all of it in ArchiMate 4. Volume 2 takes the ADM phase by phase and says which sheet, which columns, who signs it, how you know it is done, and how it usually goes wrong.

They interlock. Every step in volume 2 with teaching behind it carries a **Look it up** line naming the volume 1 chapter and section, and volume 2's appendix E indexes all 159 steps back to volume 1.

Print volume 2

Volume 2 is built to be printed and written in: 30 printable forms whose columns are the real columns of the real sheets, question sets with ruled answer space, and working tables inside the steps.

> **THE TRANSCRIPTION LOOP**
>
> Paper in the room, spreadsheet the same afternoon, repository record with a change reference. Paper that is never typed up is a wasted workshop; a record typed up without a change reference is a repository that will rot inside a year.

The notation

Everything that is architecture is modelled in **ArchiMate 4** — 42 elements, 11 relationships. The one exception is level-2 process models, drawn in BPMN 2.0, because ArchiMate has no swimlanes and in a process model the hand-off is the point. Volume 1 chapter 16 teaches the notation; volume 2 appendix D maps all 64 object sheets and 25 relationship sheets of the repository onto it, and says which 22 sheets have no ArchiMate equivalent at all.

Retail has no reference model, and that changes how you use this set

Banking has BIAN. Insurance has ACORD. Retail has an identification standard, a device standard and a process taxonomy, maintained by different bodies, covering different ground, and not reconciled with each other. There is no vendor-neutral industry model you can adopt and populate.

That is not a gap in this set — it is the industry's actual condition, and volume 1 chapter 13 says so at length. The practical consequence is that the metamodel template in folder 03 is the closest thing to a retail reference structure you will be handed, and the principles and standards workbook is where the choosing gets recorded. Nobody will name the things for you.

What the worked example gets wrong, on purpose and not

The Halverson repository is a teaching artefact and it has real defects. The books do not smooth them over — they are the best material in the set, because every one of them is a defect you will meet in a real repository.

Its index reports 842 records; its own itemised list totals 813. It claims every object type carries records while the compliance-assessment sheet is empty and the gap sheet holds a single row, so the dashboard's cheerful "gaps overdue: 0" is a zero computed over nothing. Two sheets both claim to name the golden source for a data entity and disagree on all ten entities they share, including the article and the price. Several relationship sheets pair row *n* of one list with row *n* of another, which is how Risk & Compliance comes to own Buying and a service called Space & Range Planning comes to be supported by the loyalty platform. Customer, Assortment and Planogram are all classified Public. A report asserts that three platform components are past vendor support; two are, and the third has a support end eighteen months in the future, because the column was typed rather than computed. And there is no change control at all — no version columns, no change log, no baselines. The template in folder 03 ships with those gaps fixed and says on its face what it changed.

Two invented retailers, kept apart

Milkwood Retail Group is volume 1's running example, used to make the teaching concrete, and chapter 17 walks it end to end. **Halverson Stores Group** is the retailer inside the worked-example repository. Both are inventions, and every figure attributed to either is illustrative. The worked example keeps its money in dollars; a South African reader should read the magnitudes, not the currency.

What this set does not do

It does not pick your vendor — the providers chapter names who plays in each category and says plainly, at both ends, that these are examples and not recommendations. It does not replace legal advice: the regulatory chapters tell you what the regulator and the inspector look at and which columns are the evidence, not whether your arrangement complies. It quotes no South African shrink figure, because none is sourceable, and no load-shedding number without its date and the word *historic* beside it. And it does not fill itself in, because a repository somebody else populated is a document, not an architecture.